

PHOTOSHOP · MULTIMEDIA 12 · SPRINT 4 · LESSONS 5–10 · A MESSAGE IN MOTION

MAKE IT MATTER.

Make a 15–20 second moving PSA the way an agency would: a real insight, one big idea, high-end compositing learned from the professionals, and a real next step for your audience.

14 illustrated stages

Six lessons

Scenario: youth PSA campaign

Insight · compositing · Blend If · Puppet Warp · parallax



Exemplar concept art (AI-generated, labelled). Your key art is built in Photoshop.

Teacher review edition · repaired 9 October 2026

Text, assessment boundaries, recall and navigation have been repaired. This remains a Draft: complete manual Photoshop verification, action-by-action captures, genuine mistake pairs, rendered motion review and an independent cold run are pending.

Submission: the existing project Knowledge + Reflection Form is linked below. Earlier connection receipts are retained; current school-account accepting state and revised outcome/rubric bindings remain unverified. Journal controls prepare a handoff; they do not submit evidence. No fresh dashboard synchronization is claimed.

CAMPAIGN BRIEF

A 15–20 second PSA for the school screens and social media.

Work like an agency: find an insight, turn it into one big idea, build the key visual in Photoshop with professional compositing techniques, animate it, and adapt it when the client changes the brief. Technique steps include optional professional references. Your teacher must preview them before assigning them; the linked segments have not been verified. Sprint 5 adds sound.

Approved issues

- Kindness and standing up to bullying
- Online pressure and comparison
- Loneliness and belonging
- Stress and asking for help
- Being kind online

Another issue? Propose it first. Your teacher approves every concept before production.

Safe-messaging rules (every PSA)

- Focus on hope, connection and help-seeking, not shock.
- Never show or describe self-harm, suicide, methods or injuries, and never present them as a solution.
- No blame, stereotypes or labels. Use respectful, person-first words.
- End with a real, exactly copied support: Kids Help Phone (1-800-668-6868 · text CONNECT to 686868), a counsellor or a trusted adult.
- Identifiable classmates only with clear permission.

Based on Mental Health Commission of Canada guidance. M1 M2

You will hand in

- Campaign notes, insight, big idea, storyboard (approved)
- Layered PSD and source/consent log
- v1 and v2 MP4s and a still with alt text
- Viewer-test notes and a sound plan

Help

Guided steps: the Coach explains tools and terms. The practical check is your own decisions. You can change topics at any time.

LOOKING AFTER YOURSELF You can switch topics at any time, no reason needed. Talk to your teacher or school counsellor, or reach Kids Help Phone 24/7: 1-800-668-6868 or text CONNECT to 686868. In a crisis, call or text 9-8-8. K1 K2

Knowledge + Reflection

Open this project's existing Form ↗

Use your school account. Earlier release record: 26 October 2026. Current accepting state is unverified. Your teacher releases assessment access.

INDUSTRY CONNECTION

How agencies make a PSA.

Agencies such as those behind the Ad Council's campaigns follow a fixed process: research the audience, find an *insight*, write a *big idea*, make a key visual, then adapt it across formats and test it before launch. The craft is high-end: composites where every element shares light and colour, a consistent type system, and motion that adds depth. Responsible creators also follow guidance on how to talk about mental health. M1

Study these campaigns in lesson 5

- Seize the Awkward (youth mental health)
- Love Has No Labels (bias)
- Pink Shirt Day (anti-bullying, Canada)
- Bell Let's Talk (mental health, Canada)

The professionals who teach each technique

PiXimperfect (compositing, Blend If, dodge and burn), Photoshop Training Channel (double exposure, Puppet Warp), Nour Art (high-end ad posters), Spoon Graphics (parallax). Each step links the exact lesson.

KNOWLEDGE FIRST

What makes a PSA work.

Insight → idea → action

An insight is a true thing your audience feels but rarely says. The big idea shows it in one image, ideally a visual metaphor. The call to action gives one realistic next step.

Principles of art and design

- **Emphasis:** one focal point per frame, where the metaphor is.

- **Contrast:** frame 1 to frame 2 changes light, colour and pose, telling the story without words.
- **Unity:** one grade, one type system, one idea across every frame and format.
- **Movement:** slow parallax feels reflective; quick cuts feel urgent.

Colour

The class concept uses cool, desaturated colour for its burden and a warmer shift for connection. These associations are choices to test with the audience. Aim for at least 4.5:1 contrast for small text.

Professional compositing

Match luminosity first, then colour, then direct light; blend with Blend If and masks; ground with contact shadows. Every plate must agree on where the light comes from.

Typography for motion

One line per frame, 8 words or fewer, held 2.5 seconds or more. The helpline is the most important text: bold, boxed, exact, held 4–5 seconds.

WHAT THIS ASSESSES

Skills you will show.

Skill (registered ID)	Where you show it
Audience · GD-AUD-01 · Visual metaphor · GD-MET-01	Steps 1–3, 12 and 14
Selections · PS-SEL-01 · Match light and colour · PS-LGT-02 · Blend modes · PS-BLD-02	Steps 5–7
Blend If · PS-BLD-01 · Smart Objects · PS-SMO-01 · Distort/Warp · PS-TRN-02	Steps 7–9
Colour · GD-COL-01 · Typography · GD-TYP-01, PS-TYP-01 · Hierarchy · GD-HIE-01	Step 10
Output · PS-OUT-01 · Critique · GD-CRIT-01	Steps 11–14

Primary achievement evidence: include the approved plan, distinct thumbnail alternatives and reasoned selection, editable source, observed revision and defence. the changed-brief adaptation (step 13) and the defence (step 14). Guided steps, supports and viewer tests are practice, recorded separately from achievement. Sprint: mm12-26-s04.

Image and motion evidence · course alignment

Image evidence: 1.1–1.5. Motion evidence: 2.1, 2.3–2.5 only where an actual motion product is made and tested. Cultural/historical analysis of other motion graphics (2.2) remains a separate requirement. Teacher review determines achievement.

Local mappings are proposed; existing live Form/registry bindings are unchanged. An approved project rubric binding is still required.

SESSION A · LESSON 5 · MM12-26-S04-D05

Insight first. Then the big idea.

Agencies do not start with effects. They start with an insight about the audience and one big idea that shows it in a single image.

01 Break down three professional campaigns

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: This guide · PSA_plan.txt

SELECT: Three campaigns from the list

TOOLS / ROUTE: Watch · pause · take notes

1. Open three of the campaigns: Seize the Awkward, Love Has No Labels, Pink Shirt Day, Bell Let's Talk.
2. For each, write: the audience, the insight (the true thing about that audience), the big idea (the one image or twist), and the call to action.
3. Note one craft decision in each: colour, type, casting, sound or pacing.
4. Circle which campaign changes feeling fastest, and why.
5. Share one note with a partner and add one of theirs to your list.
6. Compare two genuine published images from different dates or cultural contexts. Record maker, date, source, one visible form/content choice, one sourced contextual fact and a possible emotional interpretation for each. Distinguish observation, fact and inference; explain how context could change the reading.

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WHY

Professional PSAs work because of one insight and one idea, not many effects. Breaking them down shows the standard you are aiming for.

CHECK

Notes on three campaigns (audience, insight, big idea, call to action, one craft decision) and a reasoned choice of the fastest one. Submit the two-image contextual comparison with source links; analysis of your own image alone does not demonstrate outcome 1.2.

FIX

Can't find the insight? Ask: "What does the audience already feel but rarely say?"

Method basis: R1 · R2 · R3 · R4. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

02 Choose your issue, write the insight and the big idea

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: PSA_plan.txt

SELECT: One approved issue · one audience · one idea

TOOLS / ROUTE: Write · three thumbnails · teacher approval

1. Choose an approved issue: kindness and standing up to bullying; online pressure; loneliness and belonging; stress and asking for help; being kind online.
2. Write the insight in one sentence (for example: “Students carry worries all day that nobody else can see.”).
3. Turn it into three big-idea thumbnails, each a visual metaphor for the insight (a storm in a backpack, a mask of emojis, a cracked phone screen being taped by a friend’s hand).
4. Choose one concept and justify it for audience/message. Explain why you rejected the other two, and name a trade-off.
5. Get teacher approval for issue, audience, insight and idea before production. Tick the safe-messaging rules in Start.

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The class concept card: one line and one visual metaphor, “The weight you carry”. A card, not the finished key art.

WHY

A visual metaphor turns something invisible (worry, exclusion) into something the audience can see. Hope and a next step change behaviour more than shock.

CHECK

An approved issue, audience, one-sentence insight, three thumbnails and a chosen big idea that reads without words. Keep the selected/rejected reasons and trade-off with the concepts.

FIX

All three ideas are literal (a sad person)? Push each one into a metaphor: what would the feeling look like if it were an object or weather?

Method basis: M1 · M2. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

03 Storyboard three frames with timings

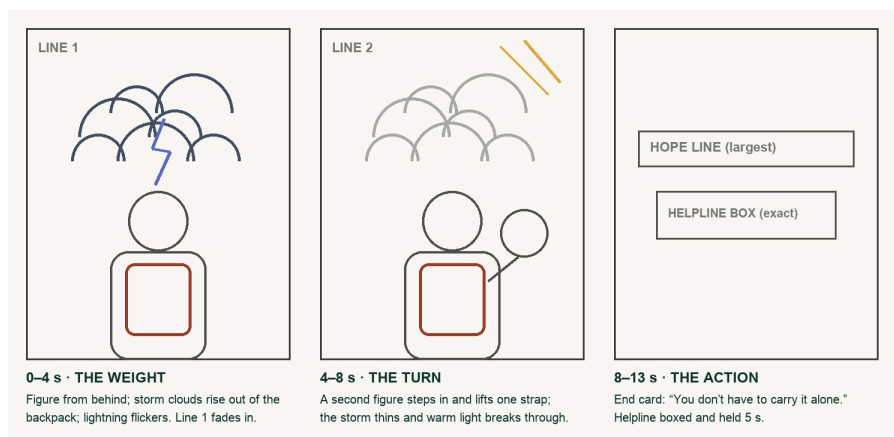
Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: Storyboard template · PSA_plan.txt

SELECT: Weight, turn, action

TOOLS / ROUTE: Thumbnail sketches · timings · movement notes

1. Sketch three 4:5 frames: 1 the weight (the problem as your metaphor), 2 the turn (hope arrives), 3 the action (end card).
2. Under each, write the timing (demo: 0–4 s, 4–10 s, 10–15 s), what moves, and the one line of text. Your baseline may run 15–20 s; reserve 4–5 s for the end card.
3. Keep every line to 8 words or fewer; a viewer gets about 3 seconds per line.
4. List the plates you need for frames 1 and 2 (subject, element, environment, details).
5. Mark where the light comes from in each frame, since it will guide your compositing.



Thumbnail storyboard of the class concept: quick shapes, timings and notes. Agencies thumbnail before any Photoshop.

WHY

The storyboard is where the ad is solved. Changing a sketch takes seconds; changing an animation takes an hour.

CHECK

Three frames with timings, movement, one short line each, a plate list and a light direction.

FIX

Frames look alike? Change one thing strongly between frames 1 and 2: colour, light, or the pose.

SESSION B · LESSON 6 · MM12-26-S04-D06

Plates and clean masks.

High-end composites start with good plates: photographed in matching light, and cut out cleanly.

04 Plan and photograph your plates in matching light

Recall · close the workbook first

1. What distinguishes an insight from a topic?
2. How does a visual metaphor express an idea?
3. Why approve a storyboard before photographing?

Answer from memory, then reopen your previous work, correct one answer and explain the correction.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: Plate list · camera or phone · starter pack

SELECT: Subject, element, environment

TOOLS / ROUTE: Shoot · match light direction · record consent

1. Decide which plates you shoot (a classmate, your backpack, the hallway) and which come from the starter pack or open-licence sources.
2. Match the light: photograph your subject with the light coming from the same side as your element plate (for example, cloudy daylight from above-left for a storm).
3. Shoot the subject against a plain, bright background so the cut-out is clean, and shoot at the angle your storyboard needs.
4. Record consent from anyone photographed, and credit every downloaded plate in the source log.
5. Import the plates into a 1080 × 1350 document as Smart Objects and roughly place them to your storyboard.



Subject plate
a student from behind



Element plate
the storm



Detail plate
lightning (Screen)



Environment plate
a school hallway

Starter plates for the class concept: a subject, the storm element, a lightning detail and an environment. All are openly licensed.

WHY

Mismatched light is the first thing that breaks a composite. Pros plan the shoot around the light in their other plates.

CHECK

A full set of plates for frames 1 and 2 with matching light direction, placed as Smart Objects, with consent and credits recorded.

FIX

Light doesn't match? Reshoot the subject, or flip the element plate horizontally (if it has no text).

Method basis: V1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

05 Cut out the subject and refine the edges

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeltMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: The subject plate

TOOLS / ROUTE: Select Subject · Select and Mask · Refine Hair · Output: layer mask

1. Select the subject layer, choose Select › Subject, then Select and Mask.
2. Use Refine Hair and the Refine Edge brush on hair and loose fabric; check on black and on white backgrounds.
3. Set Smooth 2–4 and Shift Edge –10 to –20 % to remove any halo, then output to a layer mask.
4. Zoom to 200 % and paint the mask with a soft brush to fix edges (black hides, white reveals).
5. Check the edge over your darkest and brightest background plates.

Optional reference · teacher preview pending. Exact video contents and timestamps have not been verified:

- Master shadows and lighting in compositing (PiXimperfect): the opening subject-masking section

WHY

A clean edge is invisible; a bad edge is the first thing a viewer notices. Refining hair and removing halos is standard pro practice.

CHECK

A masked subject with no halo on dark or bright backgrounds and natural hair edges.

FIX

White fringe on dark backgrounds? Shift Edge negative, or paint the edge with a soft black brush at 30 %.

Method basis: V1 · V2. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION C · LESSON 7 · MM12-26-S04-D07

Make it belong: light, colour and blending.

This is where amateur and professional composites separate: the subject must share the scene's light, colour and air.

06 Match light and colour between the plates

Recall · close the workbook first

1. How does a selection differ from a mask?
2. What changes when black is painted on a mask?
3. Why match camera height and light direction?

Answer from memory, then reopen your previous work, correct one answer and explain the correction.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeItMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: Subject vs. background plates

TOOLS / ROUTE: Clipped Curves (per channel) · luminosity check · dodge and burn

1. Add a black-and-white check layer (Hue/Saturation, Saturation –100) at the top to compare brightness only. Match the subject's darkest and brightest values to the scene with a clipped Curves.
2. Hide the check layer. Match colour with a clipped Curves using the Red, Green and Blue channels, comparing the subject's shadows and highlights to the scene's.
3. Paint light onto the side of the subject that faces your light source, and darken the far side, with Curves layers and masks (dodge and burn).
4. Darken the whole subject slightly if the scene is stormy; brighten where your "turn" frame brings light.
5. Flip the check layer on and off until the subject sits in the scene in both grey and colour.

Optional reference · teacher preview pending. Exact video contents and timestamps have not been verified:

- Master shadows and lighting in compositing (PiXimperfect): matching luminosity, colour, and ambient and direct light
- Add light using dodge and burn (PiXimperfect): painting light and shadow with Curves masks

WHY

Viewers read brightness before colour. Matching luminosity first, then colour, then painted light is how professional compositors make separate photos look like one moment.

CHECK

In the grey check, the subject's values match the scene; in colour, shadows and highlights share the scene's tint; light and shadow sides agree with the source.

FIX

Still looks pasted? Compare the darkest shadow on the subject with the darkest in the scene; they should match.

Method basis: V1 · V8. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

07 Blend elements with Blend If and ground them with shadows

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeltMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: The element (storm, clouds, lightning) and contact points

TOOLS / ROUTE: Layer Style › Blending Options › Blend If · Alt/Option-split sliders · Multiply shadows

1. Place your element plate (for example, storm clouds) and position it to your storyboard, rising from the object in your metaphor.
2. Open Layer Style › Blending Options. Under Blend If, drag the Underlying Layer black slider so the element disappears over dark areas, or This Layer to drop its dark sky.
3. Alt/Option-click a slider to split it for a soft transition. Add a mask to paint away anything that should not overlap.
4. Set bright elements shot on black (lightning, sparks) to Screen so the black disappears.
5. Ground everything: paint soft contact shadows on a Multiply layer where objects meet (under the backpack, where clouds overlap the shoulders).

Optional reference · teacher preview pending. Exact video contents and timestamps have not been verified:

- “Blend If” explained (PiXimperfect): the whole lesson; practise each slider

WHY

Blend If lets clouds and light fall naturally in front of and behind a subject without hand-masking every wisp. Contact shadows are what stop elements floating.

CHECK

The element blends with soft transitions, bright details sit on Screen, and contact shadows ground the composite.

FIX

Hard edges in the blend? Split the Blend If slider with Alt/Option for a gradual transition. Element looks cut out? Lower contrast at its edges and add haze.

Method basis: V2. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION D · LESSON 8 · MM12-26-S04-D08

The metaphor, the pose and the finish.

Build the frame that carries the idea: the metaphor element, the pose that tells the story, and a grade and type system that make it one campaign.

08 Build your metaphor with a pro technique

Recall · close the workbook first

1. Why match brightness before colour?
2. What does clipping constrain?
3. How does a contact shadow help an element belong?

Answer from memory, then reopen your previous work, correct one answer and explain the correction.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeItMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: The part of the frame that carries the idea

TOOLS / ROUTE: Double exposure · clipping masks · gradient masks

1. Choose the technique your idea needs: a double exposure (a person filled with a place), an element growing from an object (a storm from a backpack), or a replacement (a face made of emojis).
2. Double exposure: clip the place photo into the subject silhouette, set it to Screen or Lighten, and fade it with a gradient mask.
3. Element from an object: mask the element so it starts inside the object (the backpack opening) and spreads outward, with soft edges.
4. Keep the metaphor readable at phone size: zoom out to 25 % and check you can understand it in one second.
5. Add detail where the eye lands first (lightning near the head, the brightest light near the friend's hand).

Optional reference · teacher preview pending. Exact video contents and timestamps have not been verified:

- Double exposure in 74 seconds (PiXimperfect): the core clip-and-blend method
- Double exposure effect (Photoshop Training Channel): the high-end refinements
- High-end advertising posters (Nour Art): building one striking idea and finishing it



Exemplar concept art for frame 1 (labelled; teacher-supplied). Yours is built in Photoshop.

WHY

The metaphor is the idea. The technique only matters if it makes the idea read instantly.

CHECK

A metaphor that reads in one second at 25 % zoom, built with clipping and gradient masks, with detail where the eye lands.

FIX

Idea unreadable when small? Simplify: fewer elements, stronger contrast between the metaphor and its background.

Method basis: V3 · V4 · V7. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

09 Change the pose with Puppet Warp for frame 2

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeltMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: The subject (Smart Object) in frame 2

TOOLS / ROUTE: Edit › Puppet Warp · holding pins · one moving pin

1. Duplicate your frame-1 group as FRAME 2. Convert the subject to a Smart Object.
2. Choose Edit › Puppet Warp. Add holding pins at the hips, shoulders and neck.
3. Add one pin where the pose should change (the head lifting, a hand reaching, a strap being lifted) and drag slowly.
4. Press Enter. Double-click the Puppet Warp entry under the layer later to adjust.
5. Check the outline is not stretched, and repaint the mask if an edge distorted.

Optional reference · teacher preview pending. Exact video contents and timestamps have not been verified:

- [How to use Puppet Warp — photo manipulation](#) (Photoshop Training Channel): pinning joints and moving one pin



Exemplar concept art for frame 2 (labelled; teacher-supplied): the turn.

WHY

Pose tells the story without words: a bowed head reads as heavy, a lifted one as hopeful. Pins protect what should not move.

CHECK

A frame-2 pose that changes only where intended, with no stretched outline.

FIX

Whole figure bends? Add more holding pins. Stretching? Move less or raise Density.

Method basis: V5. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

10 Grade both frames and build the type system

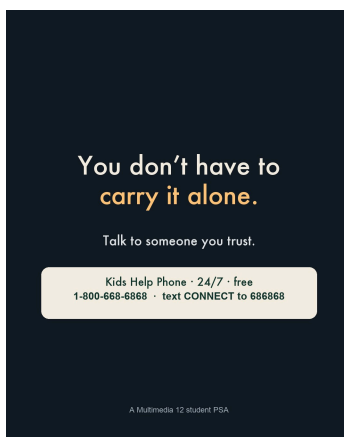
Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeltMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: Frames 1 and 2 · the end card

TOOLS / ROUTE: Gradient Map · Curves · Type tool · contrast check

1. Frame 1: a cool, low-saturation grade (Gradient Map dark blue to pale grey on Soft Light, plus a Curves vignette).
2. Frame 2: the same base with warm light arriving (a warm Gradient Map or Color Balance through a mask where the light breaks).
3. Type system: one sans-serif family, one size for lines, set in the top third, at least 48 px, with 4.5:1 contrast.
4. End card: hope line largest; action smaller; the helpline boxed and copied exactly (Kids Help Phone 1-800-668-6868 · text CONNECT to 686868).
5. Line all three frames up side by side: they should read as one campaign.



The end card: the hope line largest, then the action, then a boxed helpline that is easy to read and copy.

WHY

A consistent grade and type system make separate frames feel like one ad. The helpline is the most important information in the whole PSA.

CHECK

Two graded frames that move from cool to warm, a consistent type system, and an end card with an exact, legible helpline.

FIX

Text hard to read over the image? Add a soft dark band behind it, or move it to plain sky.

Method basis: K1 · M1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION E · LESSON 9 · MM12-26-S04-D09

Make it move. Test it.

Turn the frames into a 15–20 second moving ad with parallax depth, then test it on a real viewer.

11 Animate with 2.5D parallax in the Timeline

Recall · close the workbook first

1. Why preserve a Smart Object before deformation?
2. How does hierarchy guide the first reading?
3. Why compare frames at the intended viewing size?

Answer from memory, then reopen your previous work, correct one answer and explain the correction.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: MakeltMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: Foreground, subject, element, background layers

TOOLS / ROUTE: Window › Timeline · Transform keyframes at different speeds · opacity cross-fades

1. Separate each frame into depth layers: background, element, subject, foreground detail. Fill holes behind the subject (Content-Aware Fill) so movement doesn't reveal gaps.
2. Window › Timeline › Create Video Timeline. Set 30 fps and 15–20 seconds.
3. Parallax: keyframe Transform (scale or position) on each depth layer at different amounts. The background moves least and the foreground most. A 3–6 % push-in is enough.
4. Cross-fade frame 1 into frame 2 with opacity keyframes over about 1 second; use a smooth light transition rather than flashing lightning.
5. Fade each line in over half a second and hold it at least 2.5 seconds; hold the end card 4–5 seconds.

Optional reference · teacher preview pending. Exact video contents and timestamps have not been verified:

- 2.5D parallax photo effect (Spoon Graphics): separating layers, filling holes and animating depth

WHY

Parallax gives a still composite the depth of a camera move, and it is how many professional motion posters are made from photographs.

CHECK

A 15–20 s timeline with layered parallax, a smooth frame 1 to 2 transition, readable text timing and a held end card.

FIX

Gaps appear behind the subject when it moves? Fill the background behind it with Content-Aware Fill. Groups won't keyframe? Convert each to a Smart Object.

Method basis: V6 · A1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

12 Test on a viewer, fix, export

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: Timeline preview · a partner from your audience

SELECT: The whole PSA

TOOLS / ROUTE: Play cold · three questions · flash check · Render Video

1. Play the PSA once to someone who has not seen your plan.
2. Ask: "What was it about? How did it make you feel? What should you do?" Write their exact words.
3. Read each line aloud while it plays; if you can't finish, hold it longer or cut words. Remove flashing from the required version; use a smooth light transition. A simple flash count does not establish accessibility.
4. Fix the single biggest problem and note what you changed.
5. File › Export › Render Video: H.264, 1080 × 1350, 30 fps, as MakeItMatter_YourName_v1.mp4. Export a still of frame 2.

WHY

An ad only works if a first-time viewer gets it. Agencies test concepts before launch for exactly this reason.

CHECK

Recorded viewer answers that match your intended feeling and action, readable timing, no flashing, one fix, and an exported MP4 and still.

FIX

Viewer misread it? The turn in frame 2 is probably too subtle: strengthen the light change or the pose.

Method basis: M1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

SESSION F · LESSON 10 · MM12-26-S04-D10

The client changes the brief. Defend it.

The client loves it, but now it must run somewhere else. You decide how, on your own, then defend your choices.

13

Practical check: adapt the PSA to the changed brief

Recall · close the workbook first

1. How can movement change meaning?

2. What can one viewer test establish and what can it not?

3. Why keep the editable file with the export?

Answer from memory, then reopen your previous work, correct one answer and explain the correction.

Procedure status · not yet run end to end.

Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: Client change card · MakeltMatter_YourName.psd

SELECT: Your v1 PSA and client card

TOOLS / ROUTE: Independent response to the assigned client card

1. Save a separate v2 file and preserve your v1 export.

2. Read the assigned client card. State the changed audience or viewing requirement and predict its effect.

3. Develop and build your own response using the taught tools. Preserve the approved idea and accurate call to action unless the card explicitly changes them.

4. Test the export at the intended viewing size. Record an observed mismatch and one revision.

5. Submit v1 and v2 MP4s, editable PSD, before/after evidence and a defence of two decisions, one trade-off and a remaining limitation.

Card	The client says
1 · Story	“It runs as a 9:16 Story; buttons cover the bottom and right.”
2 · Younger audience	“It’s for a Grade 7 assembly on a big screen.”
3 · Six-second bumper	“We have 6 seconds before videos on the school screens.”
4 · Silent public screen	“The 15–20 second PSA runs without sound on a school hallway screen, viewed from across the hall.”

Independent evidence: the main achievement evidence for Make It Matter.

WHY

Real campaigns run in many formats and for many audiences. Adapting on your own shows you understand why each decision was made.

CHECK

The export meets the assigned client requirement, communicates the approved idea and has a readable accurate call to action. Your editable source and defence demonstrate your decisions.

FIX

Compare the actual result with the card and name the mismatch before choosing a tool. The Coach may explain a term; it must not decide the assessed edits.

Method basis: A1. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

14 Defend your PSA and plan its sound

Procedure status · not yet run end to end. Manual action captures and genuine lesson mistake pairs are incomplete. Earlier scripted-demo pictures do not prove the procedure. Ask for a demonstration of unfamiliar controls.

DOCUMENT: Your PSA · PSA_plan.txt

SELECT: Insight, idea, craft and safe-messaging choices

TOOLS / ROUTE: Two-minute conversation · sound plan

1. Play the PSA, then state the audience, insight, big idea and call to action.
2. Explain two craft decisions using principles (emphasis, contrast, colour, type, movement) and one pro technique you applied.
3. Explain one safe-messaging choice: what you chose not to show, and why the helpline appears where and when it does.
4. Write a sound plan for Sprint 5: music mood, one sound per frame, and where silence helps.
5. Blog: compare your PSA with one of the professional campaigns. What does yours do well, and what would you change?

WHY

Designers explain why an ad will work. For a PSA, that includes showing you handled the issue responsibly.

CHECK

A defence covering insight, idea, two craft reasons, one applied pro technique, one safe-messaging reason, and a sound plan.

FIX

Nervous? Rehearse with the sentence frames in My supports.

Method basis: M1 · M2. Values and sequence are authored for this project.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Student QA.

- ☐ My concept was approved before production.
- ☐ My PSA shows hope and a next step; no harm, blame or stereotypes.
- ☐ The helpline is exact and held long enough to read.
- ☐ My plates share one light direction; the subject matches the scene in grey and in colour.
- ☐ Blend If, masks and contact shadows make every element belong.
- ☐ My type system is consistent; every line is 8 words or fewer.
- ☐ v2 meets the client card inside the safe zone.

Copy a focused Coach context

Guided work: explain a tool, ask a diagnostic question or suggest a check. Independent practical: explain terminology only; do not choose edits or provide a model answer. Do not paste personal information.

Context to copy

Multimedia 12 • mm12-26-s04 • make-it-matter

My current step: ____

My intended result: ____

What I see instead: ____

One change I tried: ____

Is this the independent practical? ____

Explain the relevant term and ask me a diagnostic question. Do not decide my assessed edits.

EVIDENCE CONVERSATION

Keep it short and specific.

What is your insight, and how does your big idea show it?

Which professional technique made the biggest difference, and where did you apply it?

How do frames 1 and 2 use contrast to tell the story?

What did you choose not to show, and why?

What did you change for the client card, and what did you protect?

SOURCES AND AUTHORSHIP

Method references.

M1 Mental Health Commission of Canada. Checklist: on suicide — before you post or publish. <https://mentalhealthcommission.ca/public-resources/prevention/checklist-on-suicide-before-you-post-or-publish/>

M2 Mental Health Commission of Canada. How we talk about mental health. <https://mentalhealthcommission.ca/how-we-talk-about-mental-health/>

K1 Kids Help Phone: call 1-800-668-6868 or text CONNECT to 686868 (checked 9 Oct 2026). <https://kidshelpphone.ca/>

K2 9-8-8 Suicide Crisis Helpline (Canada): call or text 9-8-8. <https://988.ca/>

R1 Ad Council / Seize the Awkward — youth mental-health campaign. <https://seizetheawkward.org/>

R2 Ad Council — Love Has No Labels. <https://www.adcouncil.org/campaign/love-has-no-labels>

R3 Pink Shirt Day (Canada) — anti-bullying campaign. <https://www.pinkshirtday.ca/>

R4 Bell Let's Talk (Canada) — mental-health campaign. <https://www.bellletstalk.ca/>

V1 PiXimperfect. Master shadows and lighting in compositing (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Da4axkDKzxQ>

V2 PiXimperfect. "Blend If" explained (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ysShyX50r6U>

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V4 Photoshop Training Channel. Double exposure effect (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wrvgHDL9fc>

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V6 Spoon Graphics. 2.5D parallax photo effect (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XdYEzui3Ttc>

V7 Nour Art. Crafting high-end advertising posters (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYcxuRZfB0g>

V8 PiXimperfect. How to add light using dodge and burn (YouTube). <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbwlLjx83rg>

A1 Adobe. Create timeline animations. <https://helpx.adobe.com/photoshop/using/creating-timeline-animations.html>

Photo credits

Boxwood PS Hallway 3.jpg · ChinaFlag · Public domain · [source](#). Processed as stated in each caption.

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Figures marked Illustration are drawn, not screenshots. Step values are starting points authored for this project. Draft for teacher review; not yet classroom-piloted.

Make It Matter v2 · MM12 Sprint 4 (lessons d05–d10) · The class concept is fictional; any exemplar concept art is labelled as AI-generated or teacher-made. Support details checked 9 Oct 2026; re-check before publishing. Draft for teacher review. Repair edition 9 October 2026; manual end-to-end Photoshop test, action captures, genuine mistake pairs, motion-render QA and independent cold run pending. Teacher: approve every concept before production.